

An interesting point to note here, the Home requires to be always connected to a power supply and therefore only looks like a portable speaker.

## Features

The key feature of Home is its deep integration with Google Assistant and Google's giant bank of knowledge. Assistant is able to handle a variety of questions plus retain the context of the conversation. Only if you're willing to address it with utmost respect before each of your pleas. Home is triggered with 'Ok Google...' and 'Hey Google...' So it might become a chore to mention the two phrases before anything you have to say. Then again, you don't want Home to respond to everything you say.

Apart from all your simple queries Google is also slowly boosting the device to handle much more complicated questions. Enter the Featured Snippets. You might have come across them in your Google searches as a quick response to your answer. That little box that pops up just beneath the search bar. An algorithm scans various pages and after working with a bunch of factors, a section of a webpage is declared an answer for your query. Now Google has made its mission to make these more resourceful. So that when you ask your Home, or the Assistant on your phone, a particularly complicated question, it's able to respond with more than just Google search results.

The product is designed for far more than just talking to your AI when you feel lonely. So along with YouTube and Play Music, Home would also work with some of the major third-party services. The list includes Spotify, Netflix, TuneIn Radio and even IFTTT. The last one in particular opens up Home to a massive new world of possibilities. This not just covers the things Alexa can do and Assistant can't, but also introduces exciting new things. If you aren't aware, IFTTT (If This Then That) is a free service that lets you create small programs to perform a variety of tasks with your choice of triggers. The possibilities are endless; you might be able to make your own version of Home.

## Ecosystem

One of the main reasons smart speakers have taken so much attention is their ability to snugly fit into your home IoT. Google Home is no different. First up is Google's own Chromecast. Just when you thought a Chromecast was a major convenience, Google decided to up the game. Now, you don't even have to touch your phone to utilize a Chromecast. All the three